

Early Arrivals & The Silver Link (700s – 1600s) • The King Offa Coin (774 AD): King Offa of Mercia minted a gold coin with the Islamic declaration of faith (Shahada) inscribed on it, suggesting trade links with the Islamic world existed over 1,200 years ago. • Queen Elizabeth I formed alliances with the Ottoman Empire and Morocco to trade silk, spices, and gunpowder. • Muslim diplomats and travellers visited England in the 1500s–1600s through trade links with the Ottoman Empire and Morocco.	
The British Empire & Colonial Connections (1700s – 1900s) • As the British Empire expanded into India, Africa, and the Middle East, millions of Muslims became British subjects. • Soldiers & Servants: many Muslims served in the British Army. Abdul Karim, for example, became a famous teacher and confidant to Queen Victoria. • The First Institutions: in 1889, the Shah Jahan Mosque in Woking (London) was built. It was the first purpose-built mosque in Britain and became a hub for high-society British converts and visiting dignitaries.	
World Wars & The Post-WW2 Boom (1914 – 1960s) • Over 400,000 soldiers from across the British Empire, many of whom were Muslim, fought for Britain in WWI. • After 1945, Britain needed to rebuild and workers were encouraged to come from Commonwealth countries. • Industry: large communities settled in the "Mill Towns" in the North and Midlands, working in textile and steel industries.	
Modern Britain (1970s – Present Day) • Diverse Communities: British Muslims are not one single group, they include people of South Asian, Arab, African, European, and Caribbean heritage. • 21st Century Growth: from the first Muslim MP in 1997 to the Mayor of London today, Muslims are active in all parts of life. • The Numbers: the 2021 census shows that Islam is the second-largest religion in England and Wales.	